



New Manager Survival Guide

Your First 90 Days — From Day One to Confident Leader

Digital Workbook — \$49

by April Lewis, CEO
A.S. Business Consulting LLC

Table of Contents

1. Before You Start: Mindset & Preparation	3
2. Week 1: Listen, Observe, Connect	4
3. Weeks 2–4: Building Relationships & Understanding Dynamics	5
4. The 1-on-1 Framework	6
5. Month 2: Setting Expectations & Giving Feedback	8
6. Having Difficult Conversations	9
7. Month 3: Strategic Planning & Building Your Style	10
8. Communication Templates	11
9. Managing Former Peers	12
10. Managing Up — Working With YOUR Boss	13
11. Common New Manager Mistakes	14
12. Self-Assessment & 90-Day Action Plan	15
About the Author	16

1 Before You Start: Mindset & Preparation

"Management is doing things right; leadership is doing the right things." — Peter Drucker

The truth about becoming a manager: You were probably promoted because you were great at your individual job. But management is an entirely different skill set. The sooner you accept that being a great employee doesn't automatically make you a great manager, the faster you'll grow into the role.

The Shift in Identity

As an individual contributor, your success was measured by YOUR output. As a manager, your success is measured by your TEAM'S output. This is the single most important mindset shift you need to make.

Individual Contributor	Manager
Do the work yourself	Enable others to do the work
Your skills create value	Your team's skills create value
Focus on tasks	Focus on people AND tasks
Solve problems directly	Coach others to solve problems
Accountable for your results	Accountable for team results
Your calendar is yours	Your calendar serves your team
Feedback is about your work	Feedback is a tool you give constantly

Pre-Start Preparation Checklist

- ☐ Meet with your boss to clarify expectations, goals, and success metrics for your first 90 days

- ☐ Ask for context: What's working well? What's not? What does the team need?
- ☐ Get the team roster — names, roles, tenure, recent performance context
- ☐ Review the team's current projects, deadlines, and commitments
- ☐ Learn the organizational structure — who does your team interact with?
- ☐ Understand the budget, resources, and constraints you're working with
- ☐ Get access to all relevant systems, tools, and communication channels
- ☐ Read any recent team surveys, engagement data, or feedback reports
- ☐ Prepare your personal introduction (who you are, your leadership philosophy, what you value)
- ☐ Set up your calendar with 1-on-1 meetings for week 1

Golden Rule for New Managers: Spend your first 30 days listening MORE than talking. You have two ears and one mouth — use them in that ratio. The fastest way to lose your team's respect is to walk in and start changing things before you understand why they exist.

Week 1: Listen, Observe, Connect

Your first week sets the tone for everything that follows. The goal is simple: build trust, learn, and resist the urge to fix anything. Nothing is on fire (probably). Breathe.

Day 1: Set the Tone

- ☐ Arrive early, be visible, be approachable
- ☐ Introduce yourself to the full team — keep it real, keep it brief
- ☐ Share 3 things: your background, your management philosophy, and what you value most in a team
- ☐ Tell them what you're NOT going to do: "I'm not going to change anything in the first 30 days. I'm here to learn from you first."
- ☐ Ask each person: "What's one thing that's working well and one thing you wish was different?"
- ☐ Set up 30-minute 1-on-1s with each team member for this week

SAMPLE DAY 1 INTRODUCTION

"Hi everyone, I'm [Name] and I'm excited to be joining this team as your new [Title]. A little about me: [2-3 sentences about your background]. My leadership philosophy is simple — I believe my job is to remove obstacles so you can do your best work. I value honesty, accountability, and supporting each other. I want to be clear about something: I'm not here to come in and change everything. For the next 30 days, my primary goal is to listen and learn. I want to understand what's working, what's not, and how I can best support you. I'll be scheduling 1-on-1s with each of you this week, and I genuinely want to hear from you."

Days 2–5: Listen & Learn

- ☐ Hold your first round of 1-on-1s (see Section 4 for the framework)
- ☐ Observe team dynamics — who works well together? Where is there tension?
- ☐ Shadow team members to understand their daily work and challenges
- ☐ Identify the informal leaders — who does the team look to for guidance?

- ☐ Map the stakeholders — who does your team depend on, and who depends on your team?
- ☐ Review current projects and their status — don't judge, just understand
- ☐ Start a "parking lot" list — things you notice that might need attention later (NOT now)
- ☐ Have lunch with different team members — casual conversation builds trust faster than formal meetings
- ☐ Check in with your boss at end of week — share what you've learned, ask questions

Week 1 Questions to Ask Each Team Member

Question	What You're Learning
"Tell me about your role — what does a typical day/week look like?"	Understand their actual work, not just their job description
"What are you most proud of on this team?"	What they value and what motivates them
"What's the biggest obstacle to doing your best work?"	Quick wins you can act on and systemic issues
"How do you prefer to receive feedback?"	Individual communication preferences
"What should I know about this team that I wouldn't learn from a meeting?"	Culture, unwritten rules, history
"What does good management look like to you?"	Their expectations and past experiences (good and bad)
"Is there anything you need from me right now?"	Immediate needs and priorities

3 Weeks 2–4: Building Relationships & Understanding Dynamics

Continue 1-on-1s (Weekly)

By now you've had your first round. Starting in week 2, establish a consistent weekly 1-on-1 cadence with each direct report. These are the most important meetings on your calendar — protect them fiercely.

Map Your Team Dynamics

Use the first month to understand the human side of your team. Fill in this assessment for each team member:

TEAM MEMBER PROFILE TEMPLATE

Name: _____

Role: _____

Strengths: _____

Growth areas: _____

What motivates them: _____

Communication preference: _____

Career goals: _____

Current projects: _____

Biggest challenge: _____

How I can support them: _____

Stakeholder Mapping

Your team doesn't operate in a vacuum. Map the key people and teams you need to build relationships with:

- ☐ **Your boss:** Understand their priorities, communication style, and how they measure success
- ☐ **Peer managers:** Build alliances — you'll need each other. Have coffee/lunch with each one
- ☐ **Key clients/customers (internal or external):** Understand their needs and pain points
- ☐ **Support functions:** HR, IT, Finance — build good relationships now, before you need them urgently
- ☐ **Your team's "customers":** Who receives your team's output? How satisfied are they?
- ☐ **Skip-level leadership:** Understand the bigger picture and organizational priorities

Weeks 2–4 Checklist

- ☐ Weekly 1-on-1s established and consistently held
- ☐ Team member profiles completed for each direct report
- ☐ Stakeholder map created — key relationships identified
- ☐ Met with each peer manager for an introductory conversation
- ☐ Understood the team's key metrics and current performance
- ☐ Identified 2-3 "quick wins" — small improvements you can make to build credibility
- ☐ Started implementing quick wins (with team input)
- ☐ Established your team meeting cadence (weekly is recommended)
- ☐ Created a shared document or board for team priorities and project status
- ☐ Checked in with your boss weekly — share observations, ask for coaching

Resist the Urge: You will see things that are "obviously" broken and want to fix them immediately. Don't. What looks broken to you might have a reason you don't understand yet. By month 2, you'll have enough context to make informed changes. Premature changes destroy trust.

4

The 1-on-1 Framework

1-on-1 meetings are the single most powerful tool in your management toolkit. Done well, they build trust, catch problems early, develop your people, and create an environment where feedback flows freely. Done poorly (or not at all), you'll be managing by guesswork.

The Rules of 1-on-1s

Rule	Why It Matters
This is THEIR meeting, not yours	You have team meetings and emails for your agenda. This is their protected time to bring up what matters to them.
Never cancel or skip	Cancelling sends the message: "You're not a priority." If you must reschedule, do it — but never just cancel.
30 minutes minimum, weekly	Bi-weekly is too infrequent for new managers. Weekly keeps you connected and prevents issues from festering.
Not a status update meeting	If you spend the whole time asking "what are you working on?" you're doing it wrong. Use project tools for status.
Take notes	Shows you value what they say. Refer back to past conversations. Track commitments and follow through.

1-ON-1 MEETING TEMPLATE (30 MINUTES)

First 5 minutes — Check-in:

"How are you doing?" (Not just about work — genuinely check in on the human being in front of you.)

Next 15 minutes — Their Agenda:

Ask: "What's on your mind this week?" Let them drive. Common topics: challenges they're facing, ideas they want to share, feedback they need, career growth questions, interpersonal issues, resource needs.

Next 5 minutes — Your Agenda:

Share anything they need to know: upcoming changes, feedback you have for them, context from leadership, recognition for good work.

Last 5 minutes — Action Items & Closing:

Summarize any commitments made (by both of you). Ask: "Is there anything else before we wrap up?" Thank them.

Powerful 1-on-1 Questions (Beyond the Basics)

Category	Questions
Growth	"What skills do you want to develop this quarter?" / "Where do you see yourself in 1-2 years?" / "What kind of work energizes you most?"
Challenges	"What's slowing you down right now?" / "Where do you need more support?" / "What would you change about how we work if you could?"
Feedback	"What's one thing I could do differently as your manager?" / "Do you feel you're getting enough feedback from me?" / "Is there anything I've done recently that was helpful or unhelpful?"
Team	"How are things going with the team?" / "Is there anyone you feel disconnected from?" / "What could we do to improve team collaboration?"
Big Picture	"Do you understand how your work connects to our team/company goals?" / "Is there anything about the direction we're heading that concerns you?"

The Uncomfortable Truth: If your direct reports only tell you good things in 1-on-1s, they don't trust you yet. Silence isn't contentment — it's caution. Keep showing up, keep asking, keep following through on what they share. Trust takes time.

5 Month 2: Setting Expectations & Giving Feedback

You've spent month 1 listening and learning. Now it's time to start shaping the team. Month 2 is about clarity — making sure everyone knows what's expected and getting feedback flowing in both directions.

Setting Clear Expectations

Most performance issues are actually expectations issues. People can't meet expectations they don't know about. Be explicit about:

- ☐ **Quality standards:** What does "good work" look like? Be specific with examples
- ☐ **Communication norms:** How quickly should emails be answered? When is a meeting vs. a message?
- ☐ **Availability:** Core hours, response time expectations, how to reach you urgently
- ☐ **Decision-making:** What can they decide on their own? What needs your input? What needs your approval?
- ☐ **Priorities:** When everything seems urgent, what comes first? Give them a framework
- ☐ **Deadlines:** Are deadlines flexible or hard? How to communicate if they'll miss one?
- ☐ **Mistakes:** How do you want them to handle errors? (Hint: transparency, not cover-up)

The SBI Feedback Framework

Use the **Situation-Behavior-Impact (SBI)** model for all feedback — positive and constructive. It keeps feedback specific, objective, and actionable.

Component	What It Is	Example (Positive)	Example (Constructive)
Situation	When and where it happened	"In yesterday's client meeting..."	"During the team standup this morning..."
Behavior	What you observed (facts, not interpretation)	"...you anticipated their concern about the timeline and proactively presented a solution."	"...you interrupted Sarah twice while she was giving her update."

Impact	The effect it had	"The client visibly relaxed and we secured the next phase of the project."	"It made it hard for her to finish her point, and the team seemed uncomfortable."
---------------	-------------------	--	---

POSITIVE FEEDBACK EXAMPLE

"Hey Marcus, I wanted to call out something from the client meeting yesterday. When the client raised concerns about the timeline, you jumped in with a proposed solution before they even finished worrying about it. That showed incredible preparation and it directly led to them approving the next phase. That's exactly the kind of proactive thinking that makes this team great. Thank you."

CONSTRUCTIVE FEEDBACK EXAMPLE

"Hey Jamie, I wanted to talk about something I noticed in this morning's standup. When Sarah was giving her update, you jumped in twice before she could finish. I know you were excited about the idea — and it was a good one — but the interruption made it hard for her to complete her point, and I noticed the rest of the team went quiet after that. I'd love for you to hold your thoughts until the person finishes, then add your input. Can we work on that?"

Feedback Frequency Guide

Type	Frequency	Where
Positive recognition	Multiple times per week (minimum)	Public (team meetings, Slack) or private (1-on-1)
Constructive feedback	As soon as possible after the event	Always private — never in front of others
Performance check-in	Monthly	1-on-1 meeting
Formal review	Per company policy (quarterly/annually)	Dedicated meeting with written documentation

The Feedback Ratio: Research shows high-performing teams have a ratio of about 5:1 positive-to-constructive feedback. If the only time you give feedback is when something's wrong, your

team will start avoiding you. Catch people doing things RIGHT and tell them.

Having Difficult Conversations

This is the part of management nobody prepares you for. Difficult conversations are inevitable — performance issues, interpersonal conflicts, delivering bad news, addressing behavior problems. The good news: there's a framework that makes them manageable.

The DEAR Framework for Difficult Conversations

Step	What to Do	Example
D — Describe	State the facts objectively. No judgment, no emotion, just what happened.	"Over the past two weeks, you've missed three deadlines and arrived late to four meetings."
E — Express	Share the impact — on you, the team, the project, or the company.	"When deadlines slip, the entire project timeline shifts. The team is picking up extra work, and I'm getting questions from leadership about our output."
A — Ask	Ask for their perspective. Listen genuinely. There may be context you don't have.	"I want to understand what's going on. Can you help me understand what's happening?"
R — Request/Resolve	Agree on specific next steps, timeline, and how you'll follow up.	"Going forward, I need all deadlines met or communicated 48 hours in advance if there's a risk. Let's check in weekly on this. How does that sound?"

Before the Conversation

- ☐ Write down the specific facts (dates, events, examples) — not feelings or assumptions
- ☐ Identify the outcome you want from the conversation
- ☐ Consider their perspective — what might they say? What context might you be missing?
- ☐ Choose a private setting — never have difficult conversations in public or via email

- ☐ Schedule enough time — don't rush it into a 5-minute window
- ☐ Check your emotional state — if you're angry, wait. Calm first, conversation second.

During the Conversation

- ☐ Start with facts, not feelings
- ☐ Use "I" statements, not "you" accusations ("I've noticed..." not "You always...")
- ☐ Listen — genuinely listen — to their response
- ☐ Don't fill uncomfortable silences. Let them think.
- ☐ Stay focused on the issue, not the person's character
- ☐ If emotions escalate, pause: "Let's take a few minutes and come back to this."
- ☐ End with clear, specific agreements and a follow-up plan

After the Conversation

- ☐ Document what was discussed and agreed upon (send a brief summary email)
- ☐ Follow up as promised — lack of follow-up signals it wasn't important
- ☐ Look for improvement and acknowledge it when you see it
- ☐ If improvement doesn't happen, escalate to a formal performance discussion with HR

The Most Important Thing: Having the conversation is always better than avoiding it. Issues that are "not that bad" today become "we should have dealt with this months ago" problems tomorrow. Discomfort in a 20-minute conversation is better than months of resentment, declining morale, and a team that's learned you won't address problems.

7 Month 3: Strategic Planning & Building Your Style

By month 3, you should have a solid understanding of your team, your stakeholders, and the lay of the land. Now it's time to start thinking and acting strategically.

Measuring Progress

What gets measured gets managed. Identify the key metrics for your team and establish a cadence for tracking them.

Metric Type	Examples	How to Track
Output metrics	Projects completed, deliverables shipped, tickets resolved, revenue generated	Dashboards, project management tools, reports
Quality metrics	Error rates, customer satisfaction, rework percentage, compliance scores	Quality reviews, surveys, audits
People metrics	Team satisfaction, retention, growth/development progress, 1-on-1 feedback themes	Surveys, retention data, 1-on-1 notes
Process metrics	Cycle time, bottleneck frequency, meeting effectiveness, decision speed	Process tracking, team retrospectives

Building Your Leadership Style

There's no single "right" way to lead. Your leadership style should be authentic to who you are while adaptable to what your team needs. Consider these dimensions:

Situational Leadership: The best managers adjust their style based on the person and situation. A new employee needs more direction. A seasoned expert needs more autonomy. Someone struggling needs more support. Match your approach to the moment.

YOUR LEADERSHIP PHILOSOPHY (FILL THIS OUT)

I believe a manager's primary job is to: _____

I create trust by: _____

I handle conflict by: _____

I make decisions by: _____

I develop my people by: _____

I hold people accountable by: _____

I celebrate success by: _____

The one thing I will never compromise on: _____

Month 3 Strategic Actions

- ☐ Present your 90-day observations and recommendations to your boss
- ☐ Set quarterly goals for the team (aligned with organizational goals)
- ☐ Implement 1-2 process improvements based on what you've learned
- ☐ Start developing your team members (training plans, stretch assignments)
- ☐ Establish regular team retrospectives ("What's working? What's not? What should we try?")
- ☐ Create a team operating agreement (norms, communication rules, decision-making process)
- ☐ Begin delegating more — identify tasks only YOU should do vs. tasks your team can own
- ☐ Build in time for strategic thinking — block 2 hours weekly on your calendar for planning
- ☐ Seek feedback on YOUR performance from your team and your boss
- ☐ Identify your own development needs and create a personal growth plan

Communication Templates

Use these templates as starting points and adapt them to your style and situation.

WEEKLY TEAM MEETING AGENDA (30–45 MINUTES)

1. **Wins & Recognition (5 min):** Start positive. Celebrate accomplishments from the past week. Call out specific contributions.
2. **Key Updates (5 min):** Share organizational news, upcoming changes, or context from leadership. Keep it brief.
3. **Priority Check (10 min):** Review team priorities for the week. Identify any blockers. Clarify who owns what.
4. **Discussion Topic (10 min):** Rotate one deeper topic each week — a process improvement, a challenge to solve together, a learning opportunity.
5. **Open Floor (5 min):** Questions, concerns, ideas — anything the team wants to raise.
6. **Closing (2 min):** Summarize action items. Confirm next meeting date. End on time (always).

DELEGATION FRAMEWORK — THE 5 W'S

When delegating a task, be clear about:

WHAT: Specifically what needs to be done and what the deliverable looks like

WHY: Why this matters — context helps people do better work

WHO: Who else is involved or needs to be consulted

WHEN: Specific deadline (not "when you get a chance")

WHAT IF: What to do if they get stuck, have questions, or hit obstacles

PERFORMANCE CONCERN EMAIL TEMPLATE

Subject: Follow-Up from Our Conversation on [Date]

Hi [Name],

Thank you for the conversation we had today. I want to summarize what we discussed so we're both on the same page.

What we discussed: [Brief, factual summary of the performance concern]

What we agreed on: [Specific actions the employee will take, with timelines]

How I'll support you: [What you committed to providing — resources, training, check-ins]

Next check-in: [Date and time for follow-up]

I'm confident we can work through this together. Please don't hesitate to reach out before our next check-in if you need anything.

[Your name]

NEW TEAM MEMBER WELCOME MESSAGE

Hi [Name],

Welcome to the team! I'm genuinely excited to have you join us. Here's what to expect in your first week:

Day 1: We'll meet at [time] for an orientation and to get you set up. [Name] will be your onboarding buddy for the first two weeks.

This week: I've scheduled a 1-on-1 for us on [day/time]. No preparation needed — it's just a chance for us to get to know each other.

First 30 days: Your primary goal is to learn — meet the team, understand our processes, ask lots of questions. There's no pressure to produce right away.

If you have any questions before your start date, don't hesitate to reach out. See you on [date]!

[Your name]

Managing Former Peers

This is one of the hardest transitions in management: yesterday you were equals, today you're the boss. Here's how to navigate it without destroying relationships or losing authority.

The Realities You Need to Accept

Reality #1: The relationship WILL change. Trying to pretend nothing is different is dishonest and will backfire. Acknowledge the shift openly.

Reality #2: Some former peers will be happy for you. Some will be resentful. Both reactions are normal and valid.

Reality #3: You can no longer participate in "water cooler talk" about the company or other team members the same way. You're management now.

Reality #4: Someone who was your closest work friend may become your most challenging direct report. Be prepared.

What to Do

- ☐ **Address it directly:** Have a conversation with each former peer. "I know this is a change for both of us. I value our relationship and want to make this work. Here's what I'm committed to..."
- ☐ **Be fair — especially to your friends:** If anything, hold your friends to a HIGHER standard, not a lower one. Perception of favoritism will destroy your credibility instantly.
- ☐ **Don't overcompensate:** Some new managers become overly tough on former friends to prove they're not playing favorites. That's just as bad. Be fair, be consistent, be professional.
- ☐ **Set new boundaries:** You can still be friendly, but you can't share information you shouldn't, complain about leadership, or tolerate things you now have responsibility to address.
- ☐ **Earn authority through competence, not title:** Your title makes you a boss. Your actions make you a leader. Lead well and the respect will follow.
- ☐ **Acknowledge the person who wanted the job:** If someone else applied for your role, have a private conversation. Acknowledge their ambition. Ask how you can support their growth. Don't avoid it.

SCRIPT: ADDRESSING THE TRANSITION WITH A FORMER PEER

"Hey [Name], I wanted to talk to you directly about this transition. I know things are going to be different between us now that I'm in this role, and I want to be upfront about that. What hasn't changed is that I respect you and value what you bring to this team. What has changed is that I now have responsibilities that might mean I can't always be the same kind of colleague I was before. I might need to give you feedback, make decisions you disagree with, or have conversations that feel more 'boss-like' than 'friend-like.' I'm committed to being fair, transparent, and supportive. I'd love to hear how you're feeling about this and what you need from me to make this work."

The #1 Mistake: Trying to stay "one of the gang." When you try to be everyone's friend AND their manager, you end up being neither. You don't have to be cold or distant — but you do have to accept that the dynamic has changed, and the sooner you own that, the faster everyone adjusts.

10 Managing Up — Working With YOUR Boss

Your relationship with your boss is the most important relationship in your professional life right now. A great relationship with your boss means more support, more resources, more autonomy, and more opportunities. A poor relationship means constant friction, micromanagement, and career stagnation.

What Your Boss Needs From You

What They Need	How to Deliver It
No surprises	If something's going wrong, tell them BEFORE they find out from someone else. Bad news doesn't improve with age.
Solutions, not just problems	When you bring a problem, bring 2-3 potential solutions and your recommendation. Let them choose, not create.
Reliability	Do what you say you'll do, when you say you'll do it. If you can't, communicate early.
Context (concisely)	Keep them informed on team performance, risks, and wins — but don't overwhelm them with details they don't need.
To look good	When your team succeeds, your boss succeeds. Align your work to their priorities and make them look smart for promoting you.

Understanding Your Boss's Style

- ☐ **Communication preference:** Do they prefer email, Slack, phone, or in-person? Match their style.
- ☐ **Detail level:** Do they want the executive summary or the deep dive? Ask them directly.
- ☐ **Decision-making:** Do they want to be consulted on decisions, or do they want you to decide and inform?
- ☐ **Meeting preference:** Do they prefer scheduled check-ins or ad-hoc conversations?
- ☐ **Pressure points:** What keeps them up at night? What does THEIR boss care about?
- ☐ **Pet peeves:** Every boss has them. Learn them fast and avoid them.

Weekly Update Template for Your Boss

WEEKLY STATUS UPDATE — [WEEK OF DATE]

Wins:

[2-3 bullet points on accomplishments and progress]

In Progress:

[Key projects and their status — on track, at risk, blocked]

Risks/Concerns:

[Anything that might become a problem — flag it early]

Needs From You:

[Decisions you need, resources you need, cover you need]

The Best Career Advice for New Managers: Make your boss's job easier. If your boss trusts you to handle your team without constant oversight, you'll get more autonomy, more interesting work, and faster advancement. Be the direct report your boss brags about.

Common New Manager Mistakes

Every new manager makes mistakes. The goal isn't perfection — it's awareness. Here are the most common traps, so you can see them coming and avoid them.

#	Mistake	Why It Happens	What to Do Instead
1	Doing the work yourself instead of delegating	You're faster at it. It's more comfortable. You don't trust others to do it right.	Your job is to develop others. Teach them, set standards, and let go. Their 80% done independently is better than your 100% done in a silo.
2	Avoiding difficult conversations	Conflict is uncomfortable. You want to be liked.	Address issues early and directly. Small problems become big ones when ignored. (See Section 6.)
3	Making changes too fast	You want to prove yourself. You see "obvious" improvements.	Listen for 30 days. Then make changes with context and team input.
4	Not giving enough feedback	You assume people know they're doing well. You're too busy.	Schedule it. Make it a habit. 5:1 positive-to-constructive ratio.
5	Playing favorites	Some people are easier to work with. Former friends get more access.	Be intentionally equitable with your time, attention, and opportunities. The team is always watching.
6	Micromanaging	You're anxious about results. You don't fully trust the team yet.	Set clear expectations and check-in points. Then step back. Manage outcomes, not activities.
7	Not managing up	You're focused on your team and forget about YOUR boss.	Keep your boss informed, aligned, and supported. (See Section 10.)
8	Saying yes to everything	You want to be helpful. You're afraid to push back.	Protect your team from overcommitment. Learn to say "we can do X by this date, or Y if you need it sooner — which is the priority?"

9	Neglecting your own development	You're so busy developing your team you forget about yourself.	Read, take courses, find a mentor, join a manager peer group. You can't pour from an empty cup.
10	Thinking management is about authority	The title feels powerful. Old mental models of "boss" = "power."	Management is about service. Your job is to serve your team so they can do their best work. The best managers lead by influence, not authority.

"People don't leave companies. They leave managers." — Marcus Buckingham

Self-Assessment & 90-Day Action Plan

New Manager Self-Assessment

Rate yourself honestly on each area. Use this at 30, 60, and 90 days to track your growth.

Competency	Day 30 (1-5)	Day 60 (1-5)	Day 90 (1-5)
I understand each team member's role, strengths, and development needs			
I hold consistent, valuable 1-on-1s			
I give regular positive feedback and recognition			
I address performance issues directly and promptly			
I delegate effectively and resist doing the work myself			
I communicate expectations clearly			
I manage my relationship with my boss proactively			
I run effective team meetings			
I make timely decisions			
I create an environment where people feel safe to speak up			
I manage my time and energy effectively			
I'm building trust with my team			

Your 90-Day Action Plan

DAYS 1–30: LISTEN & LEARN

- ☐ Complete introductory 1-on-1s with all direct reports
- ☐ Establish weekly 1-on-1 cadence
- ☐ Create team member profiles
- ☐ Map stakeholders and build peer relationships
- ☐ Identify 2-3 quick wins
- ☐ Understand current projects, priorities, and metrics
- ☐ Establish weekly check-in with your boss

DAYS 31-60: ALIGN & ACT

- ☐ Set clear expectations with each team member
- ☐ Implement quick wins
- ☐ Establish regular feedback rhythm
- ☐ Address any performance concerns directly
- ☐ Set quarterly goals for the team
- ☐ Establish team meeting cadence and structure
- ☐ Begin developing team members (training plans, stretch assignments)

DAYS 61-90: LEAD & GROW

- ☐ Present 90-day observations and recommendations to your boss
- ☐ Implement 1-2 process improvements
- ☐ Conduct first team retrospective
- ☐ Create team operating agreement

- ☐ Increase delegation — hand off tasks you're still holding
- ☐ Seek feedback on your management from your team and boss
- ☐ Complete self-assessment and identify your own growth areas
- ☐ Create your personal development plan for the next quarter

About the Author

April Lewis, CEO

A.S. Business Consulting LLC

April Lewis is a leadership development expert, executive coach, and workforce consultant who has spent over a decade helping managers at every level become more effective leaders. She doesn't just teach theory — she's built and led teams, navigated organizational challenges, and developed managers from the ground up.

As the CEO of A.S. Business Consulting LLC, April specializes in leadership development, workforce consulting, HR consulting, cultural sensitivity and DEI training, executive coaching, sales training, and organizational development. Her approach is practical, direct, and rooted in real-world experience.

April holds degrees in Business, Criminal Justice, and Psychology — a combination that gives her unique insight into human behavior, organizational dynamics, and the practical side of running a business. She is OSHA Certified, FEMA Certified, a Google Developer, and holds numerous additional certifications.

Her company is SBA-certified as a Woman-Owned Small Business (WOSB) and Economically Disadvantaged WOSB (EDWOSB), HUB Certified in Texas, and holds WBE and DBE certifications with the City of Austin.

Need More Help?

Whether you need customized leadership development training for your organization, executive coaching for new managers, or a full management development program, A.S. Business Consulting LLC can build a solution tailored to your team.

Services include: New manager bootcamps, leadership development workshops, executive coaching (1-on-1), team building facilitation, 360-degree assessments, and custom training programs.

Website: choosesuccessnow.com

Phone: 512-589-4053

Email: april@choosesuccessnow.com

Location: Round Rock, Texas

Need Something Notarized?

Get documents notarized online in minutes — fast, secure, and legally binding.

NOTARIZE NOW